

JCSC OPP MODULE CAMPAIGN PLAN --- 2026 FEEDBACK

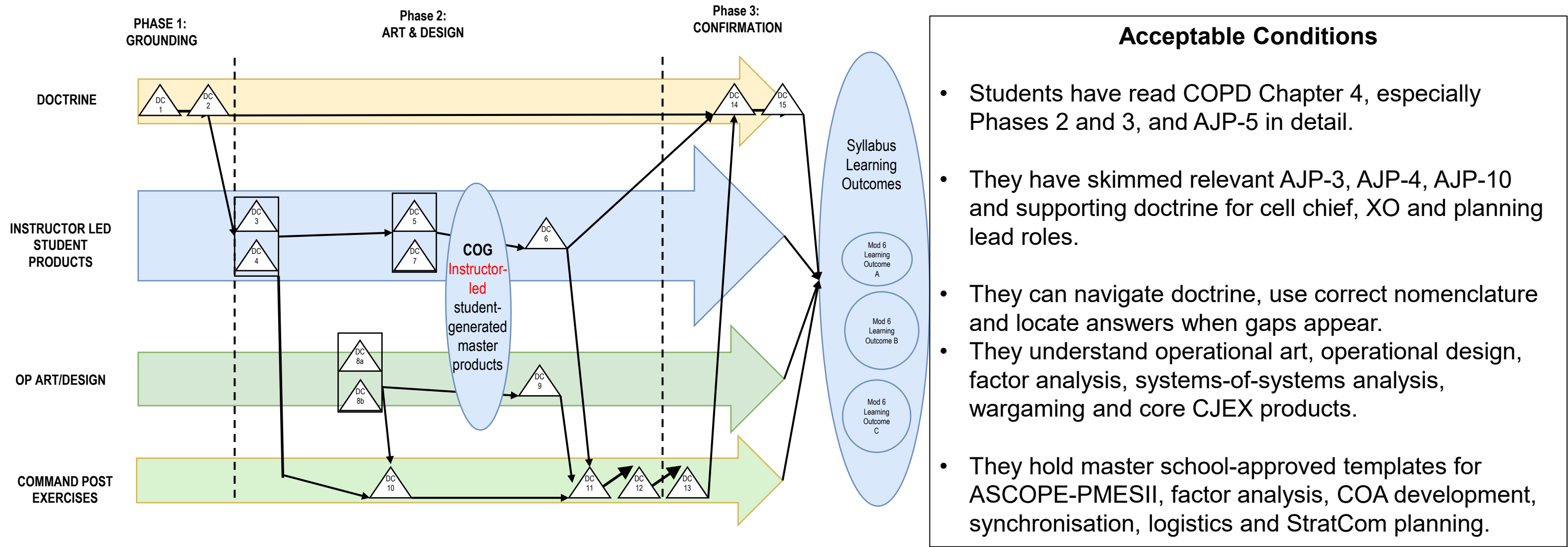
LOO	Seq	Phase	Decisive Condition	OE Ref	Operational Effect	OA Ref	Operational Action	Teaching Output / Evidence	
LOO 1 – Doctrine Orientation	1	PHASE 1	DC 1	AJP-5 and COPD are APPRECIATED as the doctrinal playing pitch.	OE 1.1	Doctrine navigation is STANDARDISED around CLEX performance.	OA 1.1	CONDUCT doctrine-navigation tutorial on AJP-5 and COPD. ISSUE a focused testing and look-up guide for COPD Ch. 4, AJP-5 and supporting doctrine.	Marked-up doctrine navigation guide. Student look-up drill.
	2	PHASE 1	DC 2	OPF terminology and component parts are UNDERSTOOD.	OE 2.1	OPF nomenclature and component relationships are STANDARDISED across the class.	OA 2.1	CONDUCT common terminology and OPF component drill covering operational art, operational design, objectives, effects, actions, COG, CC, CR, CV, PCS, limitation risk, assumption, constraint and restraint.	Shared terminology sheet. Short diagnostic check.
LOO 2 – Shared Analysis	3	PHASE 3	DC 14	Individual exam COMPLETE					
	4	PHASE 3	DC 15	GROUP EXAM COMPLETE					
	5	PHASE 3	DC 3	UNDERSTOOD	OE 3.1	Scenario information is STRUCTURED into a common analytical baseline and converted into planning implications.	OA 3.1	CONDUCT the ASCOPE-PHESISII workshop using OPEX 1 scenario. DIRECT each student individually to populate ASCOPE-PHESISII matrix with 1 factor per cell. MERGE entries into a master matrix.	Class ASCOPE-PHESISII matrix for OPEX 1 and OPEX 2.
LOO 3 – Design and COA Products	4	PHASE 2	DC 4	SOSA and actor-system relationships are UNDERSTOOD.	OE 4.1	Actor relationships, dependencies and nodes are VISUALISED.	OA 4.1	CONDUCT the SOSA tutorial in the lecture hall. DESIGNATE one student to control the shared output. Students individually read scenario and ID 2-3 dots, links, dependencies and nodes from OPEX 1 scenario.	Class SOSA map for OPEX 1 and OPEX 2.
	5	PHASE 2	DC 5	Factor analysis is APPLIED correctly.	OE 5.1	Facts, deductions, conclusions and analytical labels are DIFFERENTIATED and STANDARDISED.	OA 5.1	ALLOCATE each student a scenario factor to assess. DIRECT students to produce five deductions and five conclusions. LABEL outputs as risk, opportunity, requirement, CV, CC, CR, assumption, constraint, restraint or KCD. MERGE into master analysis.	Class factor analysis for OPEX 1 and OPEX 2.
	6	PHASE 2	DC 6	COG analysis is UNDERSTOOD and APPLIED	OE 6.1	COG, COG, CR and CV logic is DIFFERENTIATED and GROUPED in analysis.	OA 6.1	CONDUCT historical COG case-study tutorial. DIRECT individual COG analysts. MERGE possible COGs, COs, CVs and OVs. SELECT class COG analysis.	Historical COG product. Class OPEX 1 COG analysis.
	7	PHASE 2	DC 7	Risk analysis is UNDERSTOOD and APPLIED	OE 7.1	Risks are IDENTIFIED, GRADED and TREATED from the analytical base.	OA 7.1	CONDUCT the RPTA process for OPEX 1. Select OPEX 1 students to identify and rank risks using the risk analysis template. Assign students to identify and rank risks using the signed matrix. APPLY treat, tolerate, terminate and transfer.	Master risk register with treatment column.
	8	PHASE 2	DC 8a	Synch matrix is UNDERSTOOD	OE 8.1	Objectives, DCs, effects and actions are LINKED in a doctrinal hierarchy.	OA 8.1	CONDUCT group tutorial on synch matrix design. DIRECT students to derive 1 full chain themselves. 1 x INSOs, 2 x COs, 4 x DCs, 8 x OEs and 8 x OAs from OPEX 1 analysis. CRITIQUE whether each entry is doctrinally correct.	Corrected INSO-OO-DC-OE/OA framework.
LOO 4 – CLEX Release and Performance	8	PHASE 2	DC 8b	Operational framework design is UNDERSTOOD	OE 8.2	Operational framework is STRUCTURED.	OA 8.2	CONDUCT group tutorial on operational framework design.	Standardised understanding of operational framework construction
	9	PHASE 2	DC 9	Operational-level COA sketching is UNDERSTOOD	OE 9.1	COAs are STRUCTURED around objectives, DCs, effects and actions and are DIFFERENTIATED.	OA 9.1	CONDUCT group tutorial on operational-level COA sketching. DIRECT students to produce alternative COA sketches and COMPARE them against suitability, feasibility, acceptability, distinguishability and completeness.	COA sketches and comparison.
	10	PHASE 2	DC 10	OPEX 1 is STARTS as a CLEX-style rehearsal	OE 10.1	Mission Analysis Brief and COA Decision Brief standards are INTRODUCED under staff supervision.	OA 10.1	CONDUCT OPEX 1 as a controlled CLEX-style rehearsal. DIRECT each synchrite to produce a Mission Analysis Brief and COA Decision Brief using class master products. ENSURE 1 x DS per synchrite primarily present.	OPEX 1 MAB. OPEX 1 COA Decision Brief. Staff observation notes.
	11	PHASE 2	DC 11	OPEX 2 is COMPLETE as a second CLEX-style rehearsal	OE 11.1	Mission Analysis and COA Decision standards are REINFORCED and the selected COA is IMPROVED through wargaming.	OA 11.1	REPEAT Mission Analysis Brief and COA Decision Brief production during OPEX 2. CONDUCT limited wargaming. Identify one of two pairs. ENSURE 1 x DS per synchrite primarily present.	OPEX 2 MAB. OPEX 2 COA Decision Brief. Wargaming findings. Revised COA.
13 PHASE 2	12	PHASE 2	DC 12	Students are PREPARED to contribute credibly at CLEX.	OE 12.1	Student readiness is CONFIRMED and final product weaknesses are IDENTIFIED before CLEX.	OA 12.1	2 performance against CLEX requirements. CONDUCT final shared product review.	CLEX preparation pack. Readiness judgement. Final correction log.
	13	PHASE 2	DC 13	CLEX is COMPLETE.	OE 13.1	Students CONTRIBUTE credibly in JOPG roles and product effectiveness is ASSESSED through CLEX performance.	OA 13.1	PERFORM CLEX roles using rehearsed doctrine, process and product standards. REVIEW CLEX outputs against OSC learning outcomes and CLEX performance requirements.	CLEX performance evidence. After-action learning review.

Unacceptable Conditions

- After substantial syllabus time, student effort and taxpayer funding, students still arrive at CJEX with insufficient independent competence to generate core OPP products in a CJEX JOPG.
- They compensate in JOPGs through native English fluency, briefing confidence and writing ability.
- That fluency masks weak doctrinal and technical understanding rather than proving planning competence. This can make CJEX performance appear stronger than the module's underlying doctrinal effect.

Current Situation

- Students should be assumed to begin OSC with little or no working understanding of COPD, AJP-5 or the NATO OPP.
- The module therefore starts from a zero-baseline doctrinal position.
- Students may have general staff ability, but not yet a coherent map of the planning process.



Desired Future Situation (Endstate)

- Irish students contribute fully in every direction within the CJEX JOPG.
- They are credible as JOPG members, cell chiefs, XOs and planning leads because doctrinal knowledge is already in place.
- Their English fluency amplifies competence. It does not conceal weakness.
- CJEX becomes the measurement of performance used to test the syllabus learning outcomes as measures of effectiveness.

Statements of Problem

The problem is that the eighth iteration of the OSC Operations Planning Process module appears to have delivered a poor return on institutional investment. It consumed substantial syllabus time (12 weeks including CJEX), student effort and public money (circa €415k; €1666 gross salary per OF3 per week), yet produced only a fair understanding of COPD and the operations planning process. That outcome is not commensurate with the resources committed. It is also inconsistent with the requirement for Irish students to arrive at CJEX technically prepared to contribute as JOPG members, cell chiefs, XO's or planning leads.

The gap is therefore between the scale of the input and the quality of the output. The module should produce confident practitioners of the planning process. Instead, students appear able to participate in CJEX largely because they are articulate native English speakers with general staff ability, not because the module has reliably produced doctrinal and technical competence.

This product demonstrates the module's central tension: correct labels, fluent language and a plausible framework can simulate competence without it being present. The issue is not whether the product looks right, but whether the student understands it to "Operate as Primary Augmentees in a NATO combined joint headquarters" at a level commensurate with the treasure and time expended.

Statement of Solution

The solution is to redesign the OSC Operations Planning Process module as a coherent doctrinal module measured against CJEX performance. OPP is not an open-ended intellectual exercise. It is already codified in detail and to a high standard in COPD and AJP-5, with AJP-3 and other supporting doctrine used where relevant. Students should therefore be taught how to understand, navigate and apply those documents, not merely exposed to apparently-disconnected products.

Students do not need to memorise every detail, but they must understand the full playing pitch: the boundaries of the process, the purpose of each phase, the key products required and where to find answers when gaps appear. Every tool or product introduced in class should cohere directly with the doctrine and the planning sequence. The module should move from exposure to competence: read the doctrine, understand the process, practice the outputs, critique the products and apply the method under CJEX conditions.

COG Analysis

Definition of the System and Purpose. The OSC OPP module is a doctrinal competence-generation system centred on CJEX. Its purpose is to convert students with no working knowledge of COPD & AJP-5 into officers able to function credibly in a JOPG as members, cell chiefs, XO's or planning leads. The system derives educational effectiveness when staff convert doctrine, templates, scenarios, critique and rehearsal into one coherent progression from doctrinal orientation, through shared analysis and operational design, to OPEX rehearsal and CJEX confirmation.

What the System Does. The system takes raw student effort, syllabus time, instructor expertise, doctrine and exercise scenarios and turns them into planning competence. It does this by making students read and navigate the doctrine, populate common templates, build shared analytical products, understand the link between analysis and design, produce Mission Analysis and COA Decision Briefs, wargame sufficiently to improve a plan and then apply the process under CJEX conditions.

What the System Consumes. The system consumes syllabus time, student preparation, instructor contact time, doctrine, OPEX scenarios, common templates, staff critique, syndicate supervision and CJEX performance evidence. If these inputs are not deliberately connected, the system still consumes resources but produces only exposure, confidence and briefing fluency rather than genuine planning competence.

System Logic. The decisive mechanism is not the doctrine, the templates, or the exercises. It is the deliberate conversion of doctrine into **master products through instructor-led student-generated production and critique**. That mechanism links the resources consumed by the module to the competence required at CJEX. Else, the module remains busy but ineffectual.

COG: Instructor-led student-generated master products